

Alternative Names for the Civil War

The War for Constitutional Liberty
The War for Southern Independence
The Second American Revolution
The War for States' Rights
Mr. Lincoln's War
The Southern Rebellion
The War for Southern Rights
The War of the Southern Planters
The War of the Rebellion
The Second War for Independence
The War to Suppress Yankee Arrogance
The Brothers' War
The War of Secession
The Great Rebellion
The War for Nationality
The War for Southern Nationality
The War Against Slavery
The War Between the States

The War of the Sixties
The War Against Northern Aggression
The Yankee Invasion
The War for Separation
The War for Abolition
The War for the Union
The Confederate War
The War of the Southrons
The War for Southern Freedom
The War of the North and South
The Lost Cause
The Late Unpleasantness
The Late Friction
The Late Ruction
The Schism
The Uncivil War
The War

Note: During the war, the Lincoln administration preferred to use the term "Civil War," a term that specifically refers to a struggle between competing factions within the same country. This best encapsulated the President's legal theory of the war; he argued that the Confederates had never legally left the United States, and that they remained American citizens who were simply fighting against their own government. The Davis administration preferred to use the term "War Between the States," as that meshed better with the Confederacy's legal theory of the war—that the states of the South had left the Union and were now separate, sovereign entities unto themselves. Once the war was over, those two names continued to be used widely in the respective sections, while "The War of the Rebellion" was also used extensively in both sections. In the 1960s, "the Civil War" achieved national ascendancy over all other names, though in some corners of the South the alternative names are still used occasionally today, as is the more generic "The War."